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Maharashtra State Export Promotion Policy-2023 (Enclosure of Industries,Energy,Labour & Mininig Department Government Resolution No. Export 2023/CR 135/IND-7, Dated 22/11/2023)

1. Preamble :-

Export is recognized globally as an engine of economic development and growth. The Government of Maharashtra has prioritized export for enhancing the economic development and growth of the State. In this context and aligning with the Government of India's vision to make India USD 30 trillion economy by 2050, the Government of Maharashtra proposes to form an export policy to expedite the export, attract Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) and achieve the highest share of export in the country.

Maharashtra State is one of the highest contributors to India's exports and continuously increasing its share in world trade through export promotion and trade facilitation initiatives. Maharashtra is the second highest exporting state from India in FY 2022-23 with INR 5.81 lakh crore exports i.e., 17% of total exports from India. The top 10 importing countries form the State are USA, UAE, Hong Kong, Belgium, UK, China, Singapore, Netherland, Germany, and Bangladesh. Maharashtra ranked 2nd among all the States and UTs in Export Preparedness Index (EPI) ranking 2020 and 2021, published by NITI Aayog.

Maharashtra is the most industrialized State in India and has an important role in India's economy in terms of Industrial, Agricultural and Service sector export. The State continues to be the largest contributor to the national economy with a share of 13.7% of the country's GDP. The economy of Maharashtra is the largest in India, with a Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) of USD 430.62 billion and GSDP per capita of USD 2,645 for FY 2020-21.

Maharashtra Economic Advisory Council 2023 (MEAC) has submitted the report to the State Government regarding the road map for becoming $1 trillion economy. MEAC has highlighted in their report that Maharashtra, to achieve the aspirational target of increasing manufacturing Gross value Added (GVA) by 3 times to $182 billion by FY 2028. To achieve this target, Maharashtra will need to identify focus industries, attract investments, provide competitive support, develop enabling infrastructure and enhance share in Indian and Global markets. The export policy is focusing on these objectives.

Maharashtra is a leading state in a country for attracting Foreign Direct Investment (FDI). FDI equity inflow from October 2019 to March 2023 in Maharashtra amounting to INR 4,07,328 Crore (USD $53,971 Million) shows that Maharashtra has 29% share in total FDI of the country. The prominent FDI is from various sectors includes Food processing, Automobile, Chemicals, Pharmaceuticals, Metallurgical industries, Electrical equipment, Textile, Electronics etc. The proposed export policy and facilitations therein will further boost the FDI in a state.

The State has a well-developed industrial ecosystem and a conducive environment to promote entrepreneurship. To steer industrial development toward high-tech emerging sectors, 15 thrust sectors have been identified in State Industrial policy. The Government of Maharashtra has undertaken several initiatives for Ease of Doing Business (EoDB), Export promotion, Policies, Quality infrastructure and Skilled workforce which makes Maharashtra a leader in various sectors such as Engineering, Automobiles and Auto Components, Chemicals, Gems and Jewelry, Pharmaceuticals, IT, Agriculture, Food Processing, Textiles, Electronics and Biotechnology.

The State is promoting the Government of India's Districts as Export Hubs initiative to target export promotion, manufacturing and employment generation at the grass root level and to make each district accountable for the export growth. The State has identified 35 Geographical Indication

(GI) products and 72 One District One Product (ODOP) district-wise. The State ranked 5th in India for GI product registration.

To capitalize on the opportunities presented by the global market, optimize the utilization of the state's resources and cultivate a favorable environment for exports, the Government of Maharashtra is developing an export policy for the state.

Maharashtra is the Second highest exporting state from India in FY 2022-23 with INR 5.81 lakh crore exports i.e., 17% of total exports from India. The State ranked 2nd among all the States and UTs in Export Preparedness Index (EPI) ranking 2020 and 2021 among all the States and UTs, published by NITI Aayog with highest score in policy and export ecosystem parameters.

The top 10 importing countries from the State are USA, UAE, Hong Kong, Belgium, UK, China, Singapore, Netherland, Germany and Bangladesh. Top 10 exporting districts in terms of value contributing 92% of the state exports are Mumbai Suburban (21%), Mumbai (20%), Pune (17%), Thane (8%), Raigad (7%), Palghar (5%), Aurangabad (4%), Nashik (4%), Nagpur (2%), Satara (2%). Top 10 exporting sectors contributing 100% of the state exports are Gems and Jewelry (28%), Engineering (23%), Agriculture and allied (14%), Chemicals (10%), Iron & Steel (7%), Pharmaceuticals (5%), Electronics and Electrical components (5%), Textile & Apparels (4%), Plastic products (2%) and Petroleum products, Mines & Minerals (2%).

The State has 37 Special Economic Zones (SEZs), 8 Agri Export Zones and 27 industrial parks focused on exports across various sectors (highest number of industrial parks in the Leaders category as per DPIIT, Govt. of India). Industries Department being the nodal department for trade promotion and strengthening State's contribution to global exports, is continuously taking up various initiatives for Export promotion including ODOP promotion, District as a Export Hub, State Export Promotion Council etc.

2. Vision & Objective:

2.1 Policy Vision:

To achieve the economic growth of the state as well as to generate employment opportunities, the following objectives have been set:-

- To enhance Maharashtra's participation in the global value chain
- To achieve sustainable incremental growth by leveraging the export potential of thrust sectors, MSME exports
- To diversify export basket and exploring new markets for trade promotion, thereby leading to economic growth and generating employment opportunities.
- To encourage the establishment of nuclear processing based export oriented food/agro processing industries in agricultural nodes adjacent to the Samruddhi Expressway to increase per capita income of the farmers considering them as the focal point of the state.
- To develop each District as Export Hub by increasing the contribution of each district for regionally balanced development of the state.

2.2 Policy Objectives:

i. To double the exports from Maharashtra to reach US $150 Bn by FY 2027-28 from the current value of US $72 Bn in FY 2022-23.

ii. To develop 30 World Standard Export Oriented Industrial Parks in Maharashtra in next 5 years.

iii. To achieve 22% of total state participation in country's $ 1 trillion export target by 2030.

2.3 Policy Focus Areas

i. Developing State-of-the-Art export promoting infrastructure with the support of the state under Public-Private-Partnership (PPP) model to leverage the private investments in Sate's export promotion initiatives.

ii. Enhance global market access for the state's exporters by negotiating trade agreements with other countries, participating in international trade fairs and providing export-related state-of-the-art infrastructure facilities.

iii. Incentivizing the export initiatives focusing on MSME sector to enhance the exporting MSMEs, innovative ideas and world competitive technologies, adopting international benchmarks and quality standards at par in the global supply chain, incremental growth in the export etc.

iv. Institutional support and capacity building of exporters in collaboration with export promotion councils and trade promotion agencies to foster a conducive environment for export-oriented businesses.

v. Facilitating Ease of Doing Export (EoDE) by strengthening the existing institutional framework, Single Window time bound approvals, permissions, clearances at single point of contact in a digital mode.

2.4 Policy Validity

The policy will remain in effect for five years (FY 2027-28) from the date of notification or until the next policy comes into effect. This policy document will be reviewed once every two years until the end of the policy term to assess its effectiveness. However, it shall be revised earlier than the scheduled review date to address changes in laws, regulations or after assessing the policy`s effectiveness in achieving its intended results.

3. Facilitation of Exports from Maharashtra:

The major elements of Maharashtra Export Promotion Policy are as below:

I. **Creation** and **strengthening** of export promoting infrastructure and facilities.

II. **Exclusive Incentives** for the Exporters, Export Oriented Units (EOUs).

III. **Promotion of ODOP and GI products** for stimulating the exports.

IV. **Institutional arrangement** for Export facilitation.

V. **Ease of Doing Export (EoDE)** under the initiatives of EoDB.

VI. **Convergence of policies** of state government to promote Export.

VII. **Maharashtra Export Promotion Council (MEPC)** committee under the chairmanship of Honorable Minister (Industries).

4. Creation and strengthening of export promoting infrastructure and facilities:

A robust trade infrastructure for export is crucial for enhancing a country's competitiveness in the global market and promoting international trade. Additionally, modern trade infrastructure enables businesses to capitalize on new market opportunities, expand their customer base and boost economic growth. In view of the above, the Department of Commerce, Government of India had formulated and implemented a scheme called Assistance to States for Developing Export Infrastructure and Allied Activities (ASIDE) from the year 2002, revised on year 2012. The ASIDE scheme which was funded by Government of India (Department of Commerce) is delinked from support of center in Union Budget 2015-16. ASIDE scheme was offering 50% Grant-In-Aid from Govt. of India to States for developing, strengthening Export promoting infrastructure, Supportive facilities and Projects linked to export promotion. The Government of India has advised vide letter dated June 2nd, 2015 that State Government shall

make own arrangement (Budgetary Provision) for allocation of the funds for development of export infrastructure in the State.

In order to enhance economic activity, promote investment by domestic and foreign companies and to increase exports, the Special Economic Zones (SEZs) concept was introduced by the Government of India vide SEZ Act of 2005. The approved SEZ and units established therein were supported with attractive fiscal packages, direct tax holidays for both developers and unit holders. Govt. of India has applied the Sunset Clause for the SEZ which phased out all direct tax holidays for the developers and unit holders. To give the further impetus to exports, SEZ is proposed to be replaced by Govt. of India with a Special Development Hub Zones. For the said purpose, Development of 'Enterprises and Services Hubs' (DESH) draft bill is under discussion at the Parliament.

Maharashtra being a leading State in Country in terms of GDP, contributing 17% of total export of the nation and engaged in giving further momentum to the economy. State export value of 72 billion USD in year 2022-23 was recorded highest forever. In this initiative, state has kept a vision of achieving $1 Trillion economy upto year 2028. To stimulate the growth, State is focusing on export promotion and policy interventions for sector specific growth in exports considering the opportunities therein. State has adopted export centric dedicated Export oriented industrial parks as one of the ambitious initiatives to boost the export.

Govt. of India supports the industries to adopt modern technology, to increase the competitiveness in the global market under 'Technology Upgradation Programme'. Govt. of India's 'Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023' is focused on promoting Export Performance, developing 'District as a Export Hub' and trade facilitation. The FTP has kept the objective to achieve the goal of $1Trillion merchandise export by 2030 and to work towards making Indian Rupees (INR) a global currency.

Considering the withdrawal of 'SEZ' and 'ASIDE' facilities and Govt. of India's dynamic initiatives to promote exports, State decided to formulate exclusive export promotion policy focusing on State-of-the-art export promoting infrastructure and facilities. The scheme will be funded by State budgetary provision by creating a dedicated budget head. On this context, a meeting was conducted under the chairmanship of Chief Minister, Govt. of Maharashtra on February 15th 2023 and discussed the issue of supporting the projects that were submitted under ASIDE scheme, but unable to support further due to delinking of ASIDE scheme. In the meeting Honorable Chief Minister directed to move a proposal to the cabinet comprising of State's own scheme on lines of ASIDE with special emphasis on Agro and Food Processing sector so as to achieve the objective of State Government to double the income of the farmers and reduce the wastages and losses of farm produce.

In view of the above and decisions taken in meeting dated February 15th 2023 held under the chairmanship of Honorable Chief Minister, Industries department has devised the exclusive programme under Export Promotion policy. The programme Maharashtra State Export Development Programme in place of Government of India's 'ASIDE' programme. The MS-EPP is based on objective of ASIDE, to explore the export potential of the State by creating World-Class infrastructure facilities for promoting export and creating best eco-system for exports.

In order to continue its leading position in exports and further fillip, State government is promoting a dedicated export promotion integrated parks with a name of Maharashtra State Export Oriented Industrial Parks. The MS-EOIP are basically planned across the nodes of Samruddhi Highway, Express Ways, Prominent manufacturing zones, Cluster locations etc. considering the fastest and seamless movement, reducing logistics expenditure to enable exporting units to be more competitive in the global supply chain. The initiative under Export

Oriented Industrial Development Programme (EOIDP) will pave the way for increasing export share of Maharashtra and it will ultimately help in achieving $1Trillion economy of the state by year 2028. The EOIDP is an ambitious programme of Maharashtra aims to contribute total of 22% share in country's target of $1 trillion dollar export by the year 2030. The dedicated export promoting industrial parks will be developed with the support of financial assistance of state government.

4.1 Export Oriented Industrial Development Programme:

Industries Department, Government of Maharashtra has primarily mapped few of the sector specific Export Oriented Industrial Development Projects (EOIDP), shall be set up in geographically distinct areas near ports, dry ports or airports and alongside to Industrial corridors (Nodes) to have efficient logistics and seamless transportation.

The indicative list of Export Oriented Industrial Development Projects (EOIDP) is as below:

a. Export Oriented Industrial Development Project (EOIDP) along the Maharashtra Samruddhi Mahamarg industrial corridor i.e., Nagpur-Mumbai Expressway with special emphasis on Agro-food processing activities apart from other industrial sectors based on potential of the districts mapped under ODOP, Industrial Clusters, GI Products and Export potential activities.
b. Gems & Jewelry Park EOIDP based on concentration of industries, cluster of industries engaged in the sector.
c. Medtech, Medical technology EOIDP to support medical technology entrepreneurship at potential medical hubs.
d. Marine and Aqua food processing EOIDP in Costal districts, potential districts.
e. Apparel, Textile and Garment EOIDP in cotton, textile producing, processing districts and potential garment clusters.
f. Electronics System Design and Manufacturing (ESDM) EOIDP in potential clusters with set eco-system and resources.
g. Leather EOIDP in leather processing hub, footwear producing clusters, leather based eco-system districts.
h. Active Pharmaceutical Ingredient (API) EOIDP in pharma and chemical clusters with supportive eco-system.
i. Auto components and Hi-tech Engineering in auto and engineering hub, foundry and engineering clusters with connected eco-system.

4.2 Features of Export Oriented Industrial Development Programme under Maharashtra State Export Promotion Policy:

The primary objective of the Export oriented industrial development programme is to develop global standard export promotion parks with state-of-the-art infrastructure, common sharing facilities to create a conducive environment for export, employment generation and attract domestic as well as foreign investment. The scheme offers the State support by way of Grant-in-Aid for creating and developing world class infrastructure to facilitate export ecosystem. The components eligible are elaborated as below:

a) **Basic infrastructure** like Internal roads, Power, Water etc.
b) **Supportive infrastructure** like Common Effluent Treatment Plant (CETP), Cold Storage,

Ware-house facilities, Skilling and Incubation centers, Common recycling/ Resource recovery facilities, High-speed telecommunication and Internet facilities, Digital infrastructure, Plug-n-play facilities, Flatted factory complex, Safety and Disaster Risk Reduction equipment, Trade support infrastructure, Export promotion facilities for Farmer Producing Organization (FPO) such as Pre-processing, Storage (Cold chains), Pack Houses etc.

c) **Integrated Irradiation Infrastructure**, High-end technology-based facilities to increase shelf life of perishable agro-produce. Irradiation process involves controlled amount of radiant energy to achieve in habitation of sprouting, delay in ripening, killing of incest pest, parasites, pathogenic and spoilage microorganisms. This overall results in extending the life shelf life of food and agro products keeping intact the basic characteristics of the food and agro produce. This over all results in getting the advantage of export.

d) **Quality Standards** to achieve Global competitiveness and Product Standards development: Quality and Testing facilities to meet the standards of exporting countries, R&D facilities.

e) **Packaging** and Designing facilities.

f) **Green Initiatives** like, Common Renewable Energy Generation (Solar, Wind, Bio), Energy management equipment, Water harvesting, Reducing physical waste and recycling of the wastage, Disposal and sustainable handling of biodegradable wastes in industrial areas, Carbon management etc.

g) **Connected Infrastructure** like Transport and Logistics facilities, Container handling facilities like Container Freight Station (CFS), Highway connectivity etc.

h) **The project components** to meet Last mile and First mile connectivity, Need based infrastructure.

i) In addition to these the Empowered Committee (EC) may include sector specific **infrastructure** gaps, need based facilities as per the need of the project.

Note: The above indicative list mentioned should be read as a part of infrastructure projects (Export Oriented Industrial Development Programme, Not to be treated as individual units/ individual activity.)

4.3 Types of Export oriented industrial development programme proposed under Maharashtra State Export Promotion Policy:

Maharashtra State Export Promotion Policy-2023, aims to establish a dedicated export-oriented projects. The State-of-the-art infrastructure and common sharing facilities will be made available for the exporting units and potential exporters. This includes the two programmes based on single intervention and multiple interventions with a name are as follows,

I. Export Oriented Specific Project (EOSP)
II. Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP)

4.3.1 Export Oriented Specific Project (EOSP):

- Under export promotion policy, export oriented specific projects will be approved to address the specific gap related to export infrastructure/ facilities in the specific Industrial Pocket/ Cluster.

- The Single/ Multiple interventions proposed shall be within the scope of the scheme. The EOSP shall prove the direct linkages on export promotion by scientific mapping of export potential of designated area.
- The promoting agency can be public or private entity the project will be implemented on PPP mode.
- The DPR shall confirm the techno-economic viability of the project (self-sustainable project.)
- The said projects will be supported with state grant as per zones described as below with a grant limit of Rs. 50 crores per project.

The Zone wise financial assistance from State under "Export Oriented Specific Project (EOSP)":

Zone	Taluka / Area Classification As per PSI -2019	State Grant Contribution on Approved project cost	Remarks
I.	A & B	40%	• For Export Oriented Specific Projects (EOSP) projects will be supported with **Grant-In-Aid** as per respected zones concerned to location of the project. Grant-in-aid is limited to **INR 50 Crore**. • Land must be with the Implementing Agency; Cost of Land will not beconsidered in the Project Cost. • The Cost of Building (CFC, Administrative building) shall not exceed 25% of the total project cost. The cost over and above 25% shall be borne by Implementing Agency. • Limited to **5 projects** shall be permitted from each mentioned Zone. • Total of **15 Projects** in a policy period will be approved under EOSP. • The projects applied under ASIDE Scheme of Govt. of India and compiling the norms of State's export promotion policy will also be eligible under EOIDP.
II.	C, D, D+	50%	
III.	Vidarbha, Marathwada, Ratnagiri, Sindhudurg & Dhule, Naxalism Affected Areas and Aspirational Districts as mentioned in PSI-2019 policy.	60%	

4.3.2 Export Oriented Industrial Park (EOIP) under export promotion policy:

The Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP) will be a dedicated export promoting parks spread on minimum 100 acres of contiguous land for specific industries sector, related sector. The EOIP projects shall be with minimum project investment cost of Rs. 200 Crore. The EOIP projects will be also setup in the Port, Dry Port proximity area (as described in Maharashtra Port Policy) with minimum project investment cost of Rs. 100 Crore and minimum contiguous land of 50 acers. Out of total area minimum 20% area shall be earmarked for MSMEs with a name as "MSME Zone". The EOIP shall be designed in such a way that proven exporting units shall be set-up on priority basis having export value of minimum 50% of total turnover. To confirm with the criteria, the last 3 years exporting performance will be observed. The EOIP will be set-up by state-controlled agencies or private entities with high repute individually or under public-private partnership mode (PPP). The EOIP will create global standard infrastructure, connected infrastructure suitable for export, common sharing facilities and social infrastructure. The MIDC will be the special planning authority (SPA) as per provision in New Industrial Policy-2019 which will be applicable for all types of export-oriented projects proposed under this policy. In case the project area falls under different planning

authority, MIDC will approve the plan as per the DCR of concern planning authority, for which MIDC will make necessary amendments in their DCR.

The Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation Ltd (MSRDC) has planned to setup 20 Industrial nodes across the Samruddhi Expressway (Mahamarg). The MSRDC, the nodal authority of Samruddhi Mahamarg shall handover minimum 100 acers contiguous land parcel, pockets at minimum 10 locations (10 Industrial Nodes) without cost / on way of Joint venture with MIDC for the development of export oriented industrial parks (EOIP) to MIDC.

The EOIP projects will be supported with State assistance by way of grant-in-aid of total approved project cost with a cap on grant of Rs 100 Crore. In case of the projects proposed by SPV (Private entity) under PPP mode, the promoter shall establish at least one exporting unit (minimum export commitment of 60% of total turnover) with their contribution/partnership/stake of 10% in **anchor unit** in the said park with net investment not less than Rs. 20 Crore.

The EOIP will be preferentially set-up adjacent to prominent express ways, high ways, industrial corridors, ports, dry ports, air-ports like Samruddhi, DMIC etc. so as to have minimum logistic expenditure and fastest delivery of cargos. The EOIP will have the umbrella like infrastructure facilities at one location for seamless business operations.

The integrated facilities that will be available for investors are as below:

i. **Common Infrastructure and Logistics Facilities:** The **Export Oriented Industrial (EOIP) projects** aims for developing export-related common sharing infrastructure such as roads, power supply, water supply, drainage, cold storage facilities, Integrated Irradiation Infrastructure, packaging units, testing laboratories, common effluent treatment plants, other facilities required for export promotion and adequate infrastructure should also be in place to handle waste management, including recycling and disposal, as per requirement of specific Industrial sector. EOIP shall incorporate integrated logistics facilities to streamline logistics operations and reduce costs such as warehousing, coldstorage, container yards and transportation services to support the efficient movement of export goods.

ii. **Technology and Communication Infrastructure**: Ensuring reliable and modern technology and communication infrastructure, including high-speed internet connectivity, telecommunication networks and data centers to support efficient communication and data exchange with international partners.

iii. **Transportation Infrastructure:** Development of well-planned Road networks, Bridges and Transportation systems within the export-oriented parks to ensure efficient movement of goods to and from the zone. This shall also include access to railways, airports or seaports, depending on the location.

iv. **Industrial Buildings and Warehouses:** Permission for construction or providing industrial buildings and warehouses within the export zone to house manufacturing, processing, storage and packaging facilities for export-oriented businesses.

v. **Port and Terminal Facilities:** If the export-oriented parks is located near a seaport or river port, establish or enhance port and terminal facilities to handle the loading, unloading, and storage of export goods. This may involve the construction or expansion of container terminals, bulk cargo facilities, and storage yards.

vi. **Trade Support Services:** Includes support services such as Banking facilities, Insurance providers, Export documentation centers, Customs brokers and Freight forwarders toassist businesses in their export activities.

vii. **Business Support Centers:** Establishment of business support centers or incubators within the export oriented industrial parks to provide services like Market research, Training, Consulting

and assistance in accessing financing and investment opportunities.

viii. **Amenities and Social Infrastructure:** Considering the development of amenities and social infrastructure such as housing facilities (Walk-to-work), schools, healthcare centers, recreational areas and retail spaces, to create a conducive living and working environment for employees within the export oriented industrial parks.

ix. **Commercial Area:** Commercial areas will be allowed as per norms of Integrated Industrial Area (IIA). As per IIA, maximum of 40% area can be utilized for non-industrial and commercial purpose.

x. **Simplified Regulations:** EOIP shall promote Ease of Doing Exports (EoDE) with simplified regulatory procedures and a dedicated single-window clearance mechanism, facilitation for the customs clearances and other mandatory requirements, legal compliances for ease of export.

Financial assistance under Export Oriented Industrial Park (EOIP):

Zone	Taluka / Area Classification As per PSI - 2019	State Grant Contribution on Approved project cost	Remarks
I.	A & B	40%	• For Projects under EOIP will be setup in **minimum 100 Acer** contiguous land or on minimum **50 Acer** in case of **Port, Dry Port Areas**. • The Integrated facilities includes the 'State-of-the-Art' Basic industrial infrastructure, Supportive infrastructure, Export facilitating infrastructure, Social infrastructure and Common sharing facilities at single location. • Land must be with the Implementing Agency; Cost of Land will not be considered in the Project Cost. • The Cost of Building (CFC, Administrative building) shall not exceed 25% of the total project cost. The cost over and above 25% shall be borne by Implementing Agency. • Limited to **5 projects** shall be permitted from each mentioned Zone. • The projects will be supported with **Grant-In-Aid** as per respected zones concerned to location of the project. Grant-in-aid is limited to **INR 100 Crore**. • Total of **15 Projects** will be approved in a policy period under MS-EPP.
II.	C, D, D+,	50%	
III.	Vidarbha, Marathwada, Ratnagiri, Sindhudurg & Dhule, Naxalism Affected Areas and Aspirational Districts	60%	

4.3.3. Optimization of export-oriented programmes with other programmes:

State Government has already announced the exclusive policies complimentary to the export promotion, this includes Logistics Policy, IT & ITES Policy, Green Hydrogen Policy, Maritime Policy, Textile Policy etc. can be further leveraged for the export-oriented projects/parks proposed under the State's export promotion policy.

4.3.4. Eligible Agencies under MS-EPP:

The following agencies shall be eligible for financial support under the scheme and will be known as 'Implementing Agency' for EOIP and EOSP.

i. Public Sector undertakings of State Governments.
ii. Other agencies of State Governments.
iii. Export Promotion Councils / Commodity Boards.
iv. Apex Trade bodies recognized under the EXIM policy of Government of India and other apex bodies recognized for this purpose by the Empowered Committee.
v. The Private Industries / Industries Organizations/ Industries Associations can be the implementing agencies for implementing the projects either on their own or under Public-Private Partnership (PPP) mode. For this purpose, the promotors (Applicant) shall submit export centric project report, containing the background, strength, potential area of exports, financial availability, required cleared title (without encumbrances) land parcel etc. The proposal shall be supported with the vetting from Export Promotion Councils (EPC), Federation of Export Organization (FIEO). The Empowered Committee (EC) shall take the final decision for eligibility as a implementing agency (IA).
vi. Implementation agencies of the projects which were earlier placed for consideration before the State Level Export Promotion Committee (SLEPC) established under the ASIDE Scheme but could not be decided due to delinking of the scheme.
vii. Joint Venture of any of the above Government agencies where it has a major stake holding are also eligible.

4.3.5. Role of the Implementing Agency (IA) under MS-EPP:

The authorized implementing agency will own the facility created under the scheme and shall be responsible for its day-to-day operations and maintenance (O&M). The implementing agency will prepare the Detailed Project Report (DPR) and will submit to Nodal Officer (Directorate of Industries) along with the mandatory documents, statutory approvals, clearances, environmental compliances along with complete road-map and expected outcome from the project. The IA will be responsible for the overall management of the actions that will result in completion and operations of the project.

The DPR shall aimed for self-sustainable project. The DPR shall be detailed with identified critical gaps for export, the possible solutions, National and International benchmark, statistics, current scenario, existing ecosystem like human resource, natural resources, raw material, resource organizations, academic, technical and research organizations, rail, road, air, waterways connectivity, geographical aspects and advantage for global supply chain. The DPR shall clearly evaluate the measurable outcome on export performance, employment generation and attracting investments.

All procurements of Goods, Equipment and services including works shall be througha transparent and competitive bidding process as per the prevailing government procedures/ rules therein. The implementing agency shall execute an undertaking for proper utilization of grants. It shall not divert the grants for the purpose other than approval of the project. In the event of failing to comply with the conditions or committing breach ofthe undertaking, it shall be liable to refund the entire amount of grant with interest at the rate of 10% per annum. The implementing agency shall also give the undertaking that the proposed land for the project is with clear title and free from all encumbrances.

4.3.6. Submission of Project Proposals under MS-EPP:

The project proposal should be exhaustive and precise. All aspects related toprojects should be supported by data, surveys and future projections. The project must clearly bring out the identified gaps in the export infrastructure which intends to fill. The export linkages

shall be clearly mentioned, the gaps in the infrastructure which are proposed to be filled and the losses in export, missing opportunities due to lacking of infrastructure. The measurable outcomes such as expected increase in exports, reduction in logistics cost, environment protection, quality employment opportunities etc. must be clearly spelt out in the project proposal. The mechanism in Operation & Maintenance for self-sustenance of the project, levying user charges, fees will be the key evaluation parameters for assessing the project components.

The project proposal should be accompanied by an executive summary should contain the following facts

i. Name and complete address of the proposing organization
ii. Name and complete address of the implementing organization
iii. Status of the implementing agency (whether Government agency/Trade Body etc.)
iv. Total cost of the project
v. Financing pattern
vi. Whether finance from source(s) has been tied up
vii. Whether land, if required, is available for the project
viii. Project phasing and date of completion
ix. Scope of work (Type of facilities required)
x. Main benefits accruing from the project

4.3.7 Committees formed for Monitoring, Evaluation and Approval of Projects:

The Implementing Agencies will prepare a full fledge DPR containing all required details and submit the proposal to the Export Commissioner (Development Commissioner of Industries of the State). The Export Commissioner shall be the Nodal officer for the projects under MS-EPP. The infrastructure cost proposed in the DPR shall be vetted by MIDC / MSRDC / PWD etc. dealing with infrastructure development activities.

The Project Consultants (PC) shall be appointed to assist the Nodal officer from conceptualize stage till the commissioning of the project includes project evaluation, costing, design, coordination with stakeholders, procurement plans etc. The PMC will be empaneled basis on their experience, expertise in these type of projects by Empowered Committee (EC). The SICOM Limited, Mumbai in a capacity of Project Monitoring Agency (PMA) or any other agency desired by EC shall submit Techno-economicfeasibility report to ascertain the technical feasibility, financial viability and optimal utilization of resources. The Scrutiny will be conducted by the Nodal officer. The Nodal officer may take suggestions, remarks, guidance from the State corporations like MIDC, SICOM, Financial Agencies, SIDBI, MSRDC, PWD or even from Export Promotion Council (EPC), Technical expert organization as per the need of the project, before placing the same to Project Monitoring Committee. For smooth and effective implementation of MS-EPP, the following two committees at State level shall be formed.

a) Project Monitoring Committee (PMC):

A Project Monitoring Committee shall be formed under the chairmanship of Principal Secretary (Industries) for the consideration of release of funds, regular review andprogress of projects, the PMC will ensure timely and proper implementation of project without time and cost overruns. The PMC will be represented by departments such as Finance, Planning authority, MIDC, SICOM, PWD, MSRDC, MMB**,** SIDBI, DOI, EPCs, DGFT etc. The PMC shall recommend the project to empowered committee.

b) The Empowered Committee (EC):

The Empowered Committee will be formed under the chairmanship of Chief Secretary, Govt. of Maharashtra and will take final decision on approval of projects recommended by PMC. The EC will be empowered to take decisions on change the targets under each zone, the total number of projects, approval of projects/ schemes. The EC will also be empowered to add/ delete the proposed 14 sectors (PLI sectors) for eligibility of units to avail incentives. The EC will finalize the approved project cost, grants-in-aid, components wise approvals, project completion schedule and preconditions (if any). The EC will be authorized to include and approve the projects applied under ASIDE scheme. The EC is empowered to declare the private applicant entity (Private Industries / Industries Organizations/ Industries Associations) as an implementing agency (IA) for the projects proposed under Export oriented industrial park (EOIP) and Export oriented special projects (EOSP). The EC will decide the eligible project cost, the grant, the project components and completion period of the project. The EC will have the rights to curtail/ recall the State grant along with applicable penal interest in case of unsatisfactory use of grant, compromised on quality or partial / in-complete implementation project. The EC comprises of Addl. Chief Secretary/ Principal Secretary/ Secretary from Finance, Planning, Industries, Forest, UDD, Revenue, PWD, Agriculture, Transport department, EPCs, DGFT, Lead Bank, SIDBI, SICOM, MIDC, MSRDC, ECGC, EXIM and Directorate of Industries. Addl. Chief Secretary/ Principal Secretary/ Secretary (Industries) shall be the Member Secretary of the committee.

4.3.8 Allocation of the funds under Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP) & Export Oriented Special Projects (EOSP):

Implementing Agency (IA) shall be subject to the limit of the entitlement worked out on the basis of the laid down criteria. On receipt of the pre-receipt bill from the Nodal Agency nominated by the State Government, funds will be directly disbursed to it. The funds will be kept in a separate dedicated Escrow bank account of the Agencies, monitored by Directorate of Industries. The unutilized funds with implementing agency as on date, if any, out of the funds released in the preceding year(s) will be counted while releasing funds for the current year but the submission of Utilization Certificate (UC) will become binding only after lapse of the period prescribed as per GFR provisions in this regard.

4.3.9 Disbursement of funds under MS-EPP:

Funds shall be disbursed in the phased manner. The disbursement for implementing agencies will be in 3 tranches, 30% will be advance after compiling with effective possession of land, pollution control and layout approval from competent authorities and confirming with the financial arrangement by the implementing agency. Second tranche of 50% will be released after submission of UC of 1st installment (30%) and confirming with satisfactory progress of implementation. The 3rd and last installment (20%) will be released after completion of project and compliances of required conditions given in the final approval order. The project under EOIP may be proposed by MIDC, other state agencies and also by private entity under PPP mode (SPV.)

5 <u>Incentivizing the Export manufacturing units in the State</u>:

The State Government will incentivize the export initiatives of manufacturing units in the category of MSMEs and 'Special Large category'. For availing the **incentives under PSI-2019 policy**, the MSMEs are defined as the fixed investment upto Rs. 50 Crore. The manufacturing units with fixed investment above Rs. 50 Crore (MSME Limit) and below the Large category limit (as defined in

PSI-2019 policy) will be treated as **'Special Large Category'** and will also be incentivized in export promotion policy.

The aspirational MSMEs, exporting MSMEs and manufacturing units falling under Special large category will be supported to boost their confidence for making the export of their product and services. For availing the benefits/ incentives, the basic requirement of eligibility is that the unit shall **export minimum 50% (30% for SC, ST and Women entrepreneurs) of their total turnover**. The documentation, certifications confirming the eligibility shall be produced by filing the application for incentives. The incentivizing to units will be effective from April 1st 2023 to avail the benefits as prescribed in table 5.1 under export promotion policy 2023.

The Interest Subsidy Incentive shall be applicable for **14 Production Linked Incentives (PLI)** industry sectors as made eligible by **Government of India under their PLI policy**. The list of 14 eligible industry sectors is enumerated as below.

1. Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing
2. Key Starting Materials (KSMs)/ Drug Intermediaries (DIs) and Active Pharmaceuticals Ingredients (APIs)
3. Manufacturing of Medical devices
4. Electronic/ Technology Products
5. Pharmaceuticals drugs
6. Telecom and Networking Products
7. Food Products including Aqua Food
8. White Goods (ACs & LED)
9. High Efficiency Solar PV Modules
10. Automobiles & Auto Components
11. Advance Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery
12. Textile Products: MMF segment & technical textiles
13. Specialty Steel
14. Drones & Drone Components

5.1. The Package of export incentives for Manufacturing MSME, Exporting Units setup in Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP) and Outside EOIP are summarized as below.

SN	Unit Location within EOIP/ Outside EOIP	Regular Incentive as applicable to various zone (defined under New Industrial Policy-2019)	Special Export Promotion Incentive for 'MSME' category (Applicable to all zones)	Details of Incentives
01	**Units Outside Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP)**	Incentives under Package Scheme of Incentive (PSI) -2019.	1. ECGC (Insurance Coverage), 2. Interest Subsidy, 3. Special Export Incentive	1. **As applicable under PSI-2019:** For specific zone includes the benefits like Stamp Duty exemption, Interest subsidy, Electricity duty tax exemption, SGST refund etc. 2. **ECGC:** The refund of premium for first 5 consignments under ECGC. 3. **Interest Subsidy**: Interest Subsidy at 5% on 100% FCI for 5 years will be applicable to 'A & B' Zones as defined in PSI-2019 (5% Interest subsidy is already applicable to other zones mentioned in PSI-2019) 4. **Special Export Incentive:** Exporting MSMEs will be incentivized for first 5 years on incremental increase in export turnover at the rate of 1% on incremental export growth (YoY basis growth).

SN	Unit Location within EOIP/ Outside EOIP	Regular Incentive as applicable to various zone (defined under New Industrial Policy-2019)	Special Export Promotion Incentive for 'MSME' category (Applicable to all zones)	Details of Incentives
				5. **Special Export Incentive:** For Agro, Food, Marine & Aqua produce units will be incentivized for first 5 years with export promotion incentive at the rate of 2% of export turnover.
02	**Units within Export Oriented Industrial Parks**	Incentives under PSI-2019.	1. ECGC (Insurance Coverage), 2. Interest Subsidy, 3. Special Export Incentive	**1. As applicable under PSI-2019: F**or specific zone includes the benefits like Stamp Duty exemption, Interest subsidy, Electricity duty tax exemption, SGST refund etc. **2. ECGC:** The refund of premium for first 10 consignments under ECGC. **3. Interest Subsidy:** Interest Subsidy at 5% on 100% FCI for 5 years will be applicable to 'A & B' Zones as defined in PSI-2019 (5% Interest subsidy is already applicable to other zones mentioned in PSI-2019) **4. Special Export Incentive:** Exporting MSMEs will be incentivized for first 7 years incremental increase in export turnover at the rate of 2% on incremental export growth (YoY basis growth). 5. **Special Export Incentives:** For Agro, Food, Marine & Aqua produce units will be incentivized for first 7 years with export promotion incentive at the rate of 3% of export turnover.

5.2. Incentives for New MSME Entrants:

a) Assistance to MSMEs for participation in International Exhibition: The MSME participating in exhibitions promoted by Govt. of India, State Government, EPCs and other reputed organizations will be provided assistance for taking stall and displaying their products. The cost limited to INR 3.0 lakh or 50% (75% in case of Women entrepreneurs/ Schedule Caste/ Schedule Tribe entrepreneurs) of the total cost of Stall and Travel, whichever is less will be reimbursed. Maximum 2 visits shall be eligible during a policy period (one in a year)

b) The MSME exporter being the part of the delegation of EPCs, WTC, DGFT, FIEO will be assisted with the cost limited to INR 1.0 lakh or 50% for the general category and 75% for Women entrepreneurs/ Schedule Caste/ Schedule Tribe of the total cost of travel, whichever is less will be reimbursed limited to one time per unit per annum.

c) Logistics incentives for 1st time MSME exporter:

The State government will encourage to new MEME entrants for export. For the said purpose Industries department has created exclusive eco-system, institutional linkages and handholding for motivation, mentoring and guidance to MSME. For first three years the logistics expenditure will be subsidies for 50% of the total logistics expenditure. The logistics expenditure will be reimbursement limited to INR 1 lakh per MSME per annum.

d) **Cross border trade through E-Commerce Platforms and Dak Niryat Kendra:** The state will encourage MSMEs to sell their product through E-Commerce platforms in international markets. State will facilitate this initiative by arranging awareness campaign and Dak Niryat Kendra of INR 1 Lakh per consignment limited to one per annum per unit, subject to budgetary cap of INR 1 crore.

e) The Industries Department in collaboration with Service Export Promotion Council (SEPC) will take up initiatives like market intelligence, networking, advocacy, and capacity building, to promote service exports and support the growth of service providers. INR 1.5 crore / year shall be provisioned as grant in aid for capacity building / sensitization and awareness activities for exports promotion in service sector in collaboration with SEPC wherein 50% of the cost will be borne by SEPC.

f) To get financial support, Industries Department in coordination with State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC) will facilitate for getting finance under priority sector lending from banks under easier terms.

g) To help service providers access the necessary resources, facilities, and connectivity for exporting services from Maharashtra, the State government shall invest in developing the necessary infrastructure on sharing basis to facilitate service exports, such as education hub, medical hub, technology parks, state export industrial parks and industrial clusters.

5.3. The Package of export incentives for Special Large-Scale Industries (LSI) (As defined in Para 5 above) :

The manufacturing units in the 'Special Large Scale' Category exporting minimum 50% of their total turnover (30% of export turnover in case of Women, SC, ST entrepreneurs) shall be incentivized for their export performance by extending special package of incentives. The incentives are applicable to only 14 PLI industries sectors as described in para 5 above. The details are as below.

SN	Unit Location within EOIP/ Outside EOIP	Regular Incentive as applicable to various zone (defined under New Industrial Policy-2019)	Special Export Promotion Incentive for 'Special LSI' category (Applicable to all zones)	Details of Incentives
01	**Units Outside Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP)**	Incentives under Package Scheme of Incentive (PSI) -2019.	1) Electricity Duty Exemption 2) EPF Reimbursement 3) Special Capital Incentive (Technology Upgradation)	1) **As applicable under PSI-2019:** For specific zone includes the benefits like Stamp Duty exemption, Interest subsidy, Electricity duty tax exemption, SGST refund etc. 2) **Electricity Duty Exemption:** For the first 5 years. 3) **Employer Provident Fund (EPF):** EPF deposited by the employer towards employees' provident fund contribution, will be reimbursed at the rate of 50%. 4) **Special Capital Incentive (Technology Upgradation):** The manufacturing units falling under special large category will be incentivize with 'Special capital incentive for investments made in Plant & Machinery for technology upgradation purpose to meet the export standards of

SN	Unit Location within EOIP/ Outside EOIP	Regular Incentive as applicable to various zone (defined under New Industrial Policy-2019)	Special Export Promotion Incentive for 'Special LSI' category (Applicable to all zones)	Details of Incentives
				the products. The special capital incentive will be reimbursed at the rate of 30% or Rs 1 crore whichever is lower.
02	**Units within Export Oriented Industrial Parks (EOIP)**	Incentives under PSI-2019.	1) Electricity Duty Exemption 2) EPF Reimbursement 3) Special Capital Incentive (Technology Upgradation)	1) **As applicable under PSI-2019:** For specific zone includes the benefits like Stamp Duty exemption, Interest subsidy, Electricity duty tax exemption, SGST refund etc. 2) **Electricity Duty Exemption:** For the first 7 years. 3) **Employer Provident Fund (EPF):** EPF deposited by the employer towards employees' provident fund contribution, will be reimbursed at the rate of 75%. 4) **Special Capital Incentive (Technology Upgradation):** The manufacturing units falling under special large category will be incentivize with 'Special capital incentive for investments made in Plant & Machinery for technology upgradation purpose to meet the export standards of the products. The special capital incentive will be reimbursed at the rate of 30% or Rs 1.5 crore whichever is lower.

6. <u>Promotion of One District One Product (ODOP) and Geographical Indication (GI) products for stimulating the export:</u>

One District One Product (ODOP) programme is an initiative of Government of India aims at manifesting the vision of the Honorable Prime Minister to make the country and its people self-reliant by fostering the balanced regional development. ODOP is a transformational step towards realizing the true potential of district, fuel economic growth, generate employment and fostering entrepreneurship. The ultimate objective of ODOP is to convert each district in to an 'Export Hub'.

The Maharashtra has reach heritage of Art and craft, agriculture & food products, GI products, due to exclusive entrepreneurship the new age entrepreneurs producing a value-added product, technology products which are recognized in global market. In this context, Industries department, Govt. of Maharashtra has identified total of 72 products under ODOP. The two products of each district comprise one from agriculture sector and other in manufacturing sector are identified as a strength and recognition of a respective districts. The identified ODOP products in a State includes Ratnagiri (Alphanso Mango), Nagpur (Oranges), Satara (Strawberry), Kolhapur (Jaggery), Solapur (Terry Towel), Thane (Millets), Raigad (Marine Products), Mumbai (Gems and Jewellery), Sangli (Turmeric), Pune (Engineering), Jalna (Sweet Oranges), Beed (Custard Apple), Jalgaon (Banana), Palghar (Chikoo) etc. Industries department has taken below vital steps for promoting, branding, marketing, value addition in the ODOP & GI products to enable them in the global supply chain**.**

a) Inclusive and Sustainable Development: The institutional mechanism is planned for capacity building of the producers of ODOP. The district level capacity building workshops are being arranged for brand promotion, eco-friendly packaging, value addition, buyer-seller meets, best manufacturing practices, quality aspects, best design interventions etc. This will help in

inclusive and sustainable economic growth, preservation of cultural heritage and upliftment of local entrepreneurs.

b) **Branding and market linkage of ODOP and GI products:** ODOP and GI products in the state are well known for their exceptional quality. The distinctive products from each district due to geographical ecosystem, cultivation and production processes, innovative entrepreneurship adding the value. Industries Department, Government of Maharashtra taking vital steps to increase market horizons by value addition, design, excellent packaging and branding of ODOP and GI products. Exhibitions of ODOP and GI products, promotion through digital media, social media, product catalogues, coffee table book, inclusion of ODOP and GI products in gifts form for delegations, B2B, B2C meetings, participation in national and international seminars, presentations are the key interventions from Industries department for promoting "Brand Maharashtra".

c) **Capacity Building and Institutionalization for ODOP and GI product:** Capacity building programs, training programs, skill development programs are being organized in collaboration with industry associations and well-known organizations for capacity building of artisans, agricultural producers, entrepreneurs, manufacturers etc. This includes standardization of processes, proper handling of ODOP and GI products, use of environmentally friendly packaging, innovative designs, participation in e-commerce and digitization business, seminars, digital content, publicity brochures etc.

d) **Financial assistance for promotion of ODOP and GI products** :- At least 1% of the provision under export promotion policy shall be made available for ODOP, GI product branding, marketing, value addition, seminars, B2B Meetings, awareness programs for producers, creation of digital catalog, national and international events, exhibition etc.

e) **Value addition through ODOP and GI based industrial clusters:-** Industries department is focusing on value addition on ODOP and GI products by introducing the program namely "ODOP Based Clusters" under Maharashtra State Industrial Cluster Development Program (MSICDP) and Govt of India's Micro, Small Enterprise Cluster Development Program (MSE-CDP) scheme. As on date, department is working on 27 ODOP/GI based clusters and planned to add 25 more ODOP/GI based clusters during policy period. The cluster intervention will provide high-quality, State-of-the-art facility centers for value addition and quality improvement of products.

f) **District Export Promotion Committee (DEPC) :-** District Export Promotion Committee (DEPC) has been established under the chairmanship of the District Collector to promote export and to develop 'District as an Export Hub' so as to increase exports from districts. Export action plan is prepared by DEPC under the guidance of Directorate of Industries to enable ODOP and GI products as a part of global supply chain.

g) **Assistance through District Planning and Development Committee (DPDC) :-** ODOP and GI products from all 36 districts have been identified. The said products has a distinctive identity of the districts/ geographical area efforts are being made to get financial assistance from DPDC for promotion and market linkages, exhibitions and display ODOP and GI products.

h) **Financial assistance under industrial infrastructure development scheme:-** The state has made financial provision for the creation and development of industrial infrastructure for industrial estates/ clusters under last mile connectivity. The financial assistance up to 75% of the project cost is provided for the infrastructure development such as highways and internal roads, express feeders, drainage facilities, testing facilities, water supply etc. The ODOP/ GI concentrated industrial areas will be assisted under State infrastructure assistance programme.

i) **Establishing of Unity Mall :-** To promote Micro and Small manufacturing units, artisans, handicrafts, ODOP and GI products, Government of India has recently launched establishing of 'Unity Mall' in each state. Industries department in association with Urban Development Department has planned to setup 'Unity Mall' in Mumbai. This will create a lot of employment opportunities for the local youth by creating supportive industry business opportunities. Also, the economic and social development of the state will be boosted by promoting sales through start-ups, marketing platforms, e-commerce etc. The Unity Mall will give further impetus to promote ODOP and GI products.

7. <u>Institutional arrangement for Export facilitation</u>:

7.1 Market development, Skill development, Research & Development (R&D) and Quality Assurance

The state shall extend support for export-focused research with the objective of diversifying the export basket from Maharashtra, identifying new global markets, mapping new producers and exporters.

i. **Collaboration to strengthen Market Linkages:** The state shall leverage the Free Trade Agreement (FTA) signed with partner countries by India. To encourage international partnerships, the State government shall establish collaborations with corresponding states or provinces in Free Trade Agreement (FTA) partner countries, with the aim of promoting trade, investment, and economic cooperation including:
   a. Signing of Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with Consulate Generals (CGs) to promote the trade with respected country.
   b. Sign MoU with central government bodies like India Post and DGFT jointly for collaborated efforts to develop an e-commerce export ecosystem.
   c. Establishing partnerships with e-commerce companies and Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC).
   d. Emphasis shall be made on setting up Maharashtra export promotion desks in Indian Embassies abroad to promote exports and explore diversification opportunities for the export potential products from the State and also to promote investment in the state.

ii. **Collaboration with Packaging and Design Institutes:** In order to promote MSMEs for exports and make them export ready, the packaging and design of the products needs to be of international standard. Considering the importance of packaging and designing interventions, State will arrange collaboration with reputed packaging and designing institutions by making MOUs for easy access of guidance to MSMEs.

iii. **Laying Institutional Foundation for knowledge and skill development in exports:** The state through well-known organizations such as Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT), World Trade Centre (WTC), Indian Institute of Management (IIM), FIEO, EPCs, DGFT etc. will explore the development of export centric courses and training programs for exporters, aspirational youths in Maharashtra.

iv. **Tie-up for Awareness about Traceability:** Traceability is gaining pace in most of the developed international markets and there is need to increase the awareness among the exporters about it. The export cell of State shall tie up with Industry associations, Certification and Inspection Bodies such as Quality Council of India and export promotion agencies, such as the Federation of Indian Export Organizations (FIEO) and the Maharashtra Chamber of Commerce, Industry and Agriculture (MACCIA), to provide guidance and support to exporters in implementing traceability systems and complying with export regulations.

7.2 Market intelligence and identification of diversification opportunities: The Export cell shall conduct research on potential markets for export, information on market demand, import regulations, tariffs and other relevant factors. The EFC shall explore diversification opportunities for the export potential products from Maharashtra, identifying new global markets, mapping new producers and exporters.

7.3 Facilitation for export procedures: The cell shall provide guidance on the various procedures involved in exporting goods, including obtaining necessary permits and licenses, filling out required forms and documents, and complying with relevant regulations.

7.4 Facilitation for logistics: The Maharashtra Export Facilitation Cell shall provide guidance on shipping and logistics, including finding reliable transportation and logistics providers, customs, and other regulatory authorities, and ensuring timely delivery of products.

7.5 Support for product development and quality standards: The cell shall assist exporters in developing products that meet the quality standards and specifications required by the target market. This shall include facilitation with product design, testing and certification.

7.6 Facilitation with finance and incentives: The Maharashtra Export Facilitation Cell shall provide information on available financing options, including export credit and insurance, as well as government incentives and support programs for exporters.

7.7 Promotion and marketing: The export cell shall arrange B2B meets (Buyer-Sellers meets) in association with trade bodies, consulates, organizations like World Trade Centre (WTC) to help exporters for market linkages, brand promotion etc.

7.8 Training and capacity building: The Cell shall provide training and capacity building programs for exporters to sensitize them and help them enhance their knowledge and skills related to export procedures, quality standards, marketing strategies, and other relevant topics.

7.9 Export Awards: The State Government facilitate the best performing exporters by conferring export awards at the state level event. The main objective to greet the best performing exporters is to recognize and appreciate the meritorious export performance of exporters and to encourage them for better and higher export performance in future. The awards will be in the form of memento or cheque.

7.10 Maha Export Portal: The State will have a dedicated portal for disseminating knowledge and information for exporters, regular updates, export opportunities, world and nation wid events, government initiatives and notifications etc. The dynamic online portal, integrated with state single window portal will facilitate Ease of doing Exports and addressing the grievances (if any) in time bound manner.

8. <u>Ease of Doing Export (EoDE) under the initiatives of EoDB:</u>

8.1 Export Promotion and Assistance cell at MAITRI:

i. To promote exports, a facilitation framework has been set up in the State in the form of the Maharashtra Export Promotion Council (MEPC) chaired by Industries Minister, Govt of Maharashtra. District Export Promotion Councils (DEPC) chaired by District Collector. Development Commissioner (Industries) is a State Export Commissioner will act as a 'Nodal Officer' for implementation of export promotion policy. Further to ensure effective implementation and monitoring of the Export Policy of the State and to facilitate the potential and existing exporters, the Maharashtra Government shall establish an Export Facilitation Cell (EFC) under Export Commissioner in State's Single Window platform viz. 'Maharashtra Industry Trade & Investment Facilitation Cell (MAITRI)'. The Export cell in MAITRI will comprise the domain experts from various fields related to export activities. The guidance and mentoring cell at MAITRI will give the handholding support for aspirational MSMEs, the first-time exporting units. The Export cell will make an tie-up with

reputed organizations, experts, financial institutions which will includes Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), World Trade Centre (WTC) and Federation of Indian Export Organizations (FIEO) and EPCs, EXIM bank, SIDBI, ECGC etc.

ii. State Government is prepared for establishing 'Unity Mall' to promote the art and craft, ODOP and GI products of each state as per the initiatives of Government of India. This will ultimately explore the branding of the prominent products of each district and shall be helpful for promoting the export.

iii. Export Commissioner shall monitor and will take regular reviews of District Export Promotion Committee (DEPC) meetings, implementation of District Export Action Plan (DEAP) and District as Export Hub (DEH) initiative, ODOP & GI promotion and etc.

iv. The Regional Joint Directors (Industries) and the General Managers (DIC) shall be designated as Regional Export Officers and District Export Promotion Officers in EFC to make each region and district accountable for the State's export growth.

v. The main objective of Export cell is to provide comprehensive guidance and assistance to potential exporters by exploring Central and State government synergy, improve competitiveness in the global market by product development packaging, marketing and branding, compliance with standards and regulations, logistics etc.

vi. The EFC shall act as a single window and offer services to exporters from the state in the following areas:

a) **Single Window Clearance:** The state single window portal, Maharashtra Industry Trade & Investment Facilitation Cell (MAITRI) portal will act as single window clearance for securing all business related & export related approvals/licenses/ clearances/NOC.

b) **Facilitation for Grievance Redressal:** To provide follow-up and resolution of issues relating to export grievances the Trade Disputes Cell in the DGFT Office has been functional. The EFC will act as a coordinator for issues to be taken up or follow-up of the disputes of exporters and importers with the said Grievance Cell and shall be responsive for any of the action to be taken up at grass root level, for compliance. The EFC shall have a functional online grievance redressal portal exclusively for exporters in which exporters can flag key issues of concern that requires government intervention. In order to ensure synergy between Centre and the State, EFC will act as State-Centre coordination cell to review and act upon new developments that are important for State's exports. The cell shall act as a bridge between exporters and the government, coordinate with Central Government departments and other export-related concerned agencies to assists in addressing regulatory hurdles or issues that may arise during the export process.

8.2 Maharashtra International Trade Fair (MITF): An annual international export promotion event shall be organized by the State to promote "Brand Maharashtra" through local products and focused on facilitating market access for exporters and promoting trade.

8.3 State participation in National and International Exhibition: Maharashtra Pavilion in national and international exhibitions to promote ODOP and GI products under "**BRAND MAHARASHTRA**".

9. Convergence of other policies of State government to promote export:

9.1 During recent years, Maharashtra has launched/ amended sector-specific export policies, which shall be dovetailed with Maharashtra Export Promotion Policy.

9.2 Notwithstanding any of the above, State Government has made special provisions in various sector specific export policies for the State.

These policies are:

i. Agriculture Export Policy (AEP) of Maharashtra State 2022.
ii. Aerospace & Defence Manufacturing Policy 2018.
iii. Policy for Industrial Parks comprising of flatted galas for Readymade Garment manufacturing, Gems & Jewellery, Micro Electronics and Engineering units policy.
iv. Fintech Policy.
v. Maharashtra Coir Policy.
vi. Electrical Vehicle and Related Infrastructure Policy.
vii. Logistics Parks Policy.
viii. Textile Policy.
ix. IT/ITeS Policy.
x. Electronics Policy.
xi. Retail Trade Policy.
xii. Incentive for Development of Integrated Industrial Area (IIA).
xiii. Chief Minister Employment Generation Programme (CMEGP) / Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)
xiv. Women Entrepreneur Policy
xv. Bharat Ratna Dr. Baba Saheb Ambedkar Special Package of Scheme Incentive for SC/ST Entrepreneurs.
xvi. Leather and footwear policy.
xvii. New Maritime port policy.
xviii. Green Hydrogen Policy.

9.3 The prevailing sector-specific policies bear reference to Industrial Policy of Maharashtra 2019, and its General Rules/ Package Scheme of Incentives (PSI), respectively, unless specified otherwise.

9.4 The eligible units under various policies will be allowed to avail incentives in Maharashtra export promotion policy over and above the existing policies.

10. Maharashtra Export Promotion Council (MEPC):

Maharashtra Export Promotion Council (MPEC) chaired by Honorable Minister (Industries) and having members of various departments of State Government, Central Government will guide and give appropriate directives for smooth and effective implementation of Maharashtra Export Promotion Policy. The committee will suggest any modifications, suggestions, additions in implementation of the scheme considering the need of industries. The committee will conduct the consultations with National / International institutions, Experts for best outcome of the policy initiatives.

MEPC in consultation with Stakeholders, Exporters, Export organizations, Central organizations etc. will take a review on progress of policy, will make necessary MOUs for expert organizations for smooth implementation of the export policy.

MEPC will take mid-term review after every two years for getting suggestions and will also consider the Central government directives given time to time in respect to export promotion so as to have best outcome of export policy and accordingly will give directions for necessary corrections/ amendments required in the export policy.

This policy document will be reviewed once every two years until the end of the policy term to assess its effectiveness. However, it shall be revised earlier than the scheduled review date to address changes in laws, regulations or after assessing the policy's effectiveness in achieving its intended results.

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